UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE

Performing Lobby Assistance

Participant Guide

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Employee Resource Management

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE

Performing Lobby Assistance

Participant Guide

United States Postal Service
Employee Resource Management
475 L'Enfant Plaza SW
Washington, DC 20260-4215

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The Postal Service's policy is to value the diversity of our employees, customers and suppliers, and to do what is right for our employees and the communities we serve, thereby ensuring a competitive advantage in the global marketplace.

Table of Contents

Module 1: Performing Lobby Assistance 1-1

Effective Lobby Assistance 1-3
Preparing the Customer for Retail Counter 1-4
Directing the Customer to the Self-Service Kiosk (SSK) 1-7
Tools for Lobby Assistants 1-11
Ancillary Duties as a Lobby Assistant 1-12
Summary 1-14

Module 2: Self-Service Kiosk (SSK) Guidelines 2-1

Self-Service Kiosk 2-3
SSK Component Overview 2-3
Handicap, Hearing, and Visually Impaired Accessories 2-5
Responsibilities of a Servicing Employee 2-6
Alert Types 2-10
Help Desk 2-11
Key and Refund Policies 2-14
Resources 2-17
Summary 2-19

Appendix 21

Module 1: Performing Lobby Assistance

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Demonstrate effective lobby assistance
- Prepare customers for the Retail Counter
- Direct customers to the Self-Service Kiosks

Time Allocated for Module:

- 60 Minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Lecture
- Group Discussion
- Group Activities

Summary:

- Approaching Customers in the Lobby
- Preparing Customers for the Retail Counter
- Directing Customers to the Self-Service Kiosk
- Ancillary Duties for the Lobby Assistant

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- ACE Computer, LCD projector, and PowerPoint presentation

Effective Lobby Assistance

Having a Lobby Assistant in the lobby will reduce the amount of time that the SSAs at the window will need to spend with unprepared customers. Many times customers come into the Post Office not fully prepared for their retail transaction. They may be uncertain of the products, may not know what forms are needed or may have incomplete applications. When these customers reach the retail counter, the Sales and Service Associate (SSA) will need to spend extra time explaining products and services to indecisive customers, waiting for them to complete forms and applications, and answering questions. This can create a bottleneck if the transactions become lengthy.

A Lobby Assistant should engage customers as they arrive in the lobby to discuss their needs, answer questions and assist with preparing them for their transaction. Customers that are fully prepared prior to reaching the retail window have more efficient and quicker transactions at the counter than unprepared customers. Having prepared customers will result in decreased wait time and more knowledgeable customers.

Sales and Service Associates (SSAs) have the postal expertise that is required for successful lobby assistance. SSAs are able to more efficiently answer questions about products and services and offer suggestions to meet customer needs. As a Lobby Assistant, they will be performing their SSA duties using their postal knowledge in the lobby rather than behind a POS machine. The Lobby Assistant should be able to display self-initiative, perform with assertiveness and be able to articulate the benefits and features of products and services to the customer.

Lobby Assistant Responsibilities

Lobby Assistants are postal ambassadors, representing and promoting the USPS products and services. The Lobby Assistant should be neat and presentable and wear a full uniform that identifies them as a postal employee. By using their postal knowledge to engage the customer they can satisfy customer needs and increase customer satisfaction and positively promote the USPS brand.

Lobby Assistants will assess the customer's needs as they arrive in the lobby in order to assist them with preparing for their retail transactions. They should do this while practicing good customer service - smiling, being professional, and having a good attitude. However, while a pleasant greeting is necessary, it is not the sole purpose of a Lobby Assistant to be a "greeter." The primary goal is to enhance the customer experience by engaging and assisting the customers.

Lobby Assistants should be present in the lobby at all times the window is open and should not move to behind the counter, even if customer traffic briefly becomes slow. The traffic will pick up and the Lobby Assistants need to be ready in the inner lobby in order to create a positive customer experience.

Lobby Assistants should monitor their lobby to ensure it presents a clean, professional image to customers. Any down time should be used to straighten lobby, and replenish ReadyPost, Express and Priority supplies and forms. Debris should be removed from counters and writing tables.

Approaching Customers in the Lobby

Lobby Assistants will likely be the first retail associate the customer meets when they arrive in the lobby. First impressions matter! As a postal ambassador, the Lobby Assistants must be professional, friendly, and helpful. Their goal is to greet customers, inquire to identify the customer's transaction needs, and provide assistance. Lobby Assistants should not be overly aggressive but should be assertive and confident.

Lobby Assistants should approach and greet customers as they enter the lobby. For effective lobby assistance, a customer should not reach the retail counter unless the lobby assistant has first determined if their transaction could be directed to the Self-Service Kiosk (if applicable) or Retail Customs Terminal (RCT) and to assess if they are fully prepared or need additional assistance.

The Lobby Assistant will need to ask questions to identify the customer's needs. Same as the SSAs behind the counter, the "Greet, Inquire, Suggest and Thank" (GIST) techniques should be used by Lobby Assistants when communicating with the customers. Using this method will effectively assess the customer needs by having the Lobby Assistant ask questions and make suggestions based on the responses. Although the Lobby Assistant is not behind the counter with a POS terminal, their postal expertise is what makes their assistance so critical and valuable.

Preparing the Customer for Retail Counter

When customers are prepared, it reduces the amount of time that the SSA will need to complete transactions at the window, resulting in a reduction of wait time in line for all customers.

Some of the causes of lengthy transactions include:

- Unprepared customers
- Indecision on products or services to purchase

- Incomplete forms
- Parcel pickups or Hold Mail
- New PO Box rentals
- Passports
- Customer Inquiry
- Items requiring Custom's Forms

Lobby Assistants will need to ask questions to determine the need and then offer suggestions to assist the customer in properly preparing for their transaction. The goal is to have the customers fully prepared and informed so the SSAs at the window only have to "ring them up" on POS.

Mailing/Package Transactions

For packages and/or mailings, the Lobby Assistant can make the transactions more efficient by these methods:

- Make sure the packages are addressed completely and packaged properly.
- Direct customer to the Self-Service Kiosk if eligible (if applicable)
- Ask the required questions for the Retail Customer Experience (RCE) survey to determine services and product needs.
- Explain any product and service features.
- Ask the HAZMAT question and mark the package with initials in the corner so Sales and Services Associates (SSAs) at the counter know the customer has been asked.
- Explain any required forms and have the customer complete prior to reaching the counter.
- Carry a tape measure and measure any large packages. Record the size dimensions on the package for the SSA to input.
- Explain customs forms and have customer complete or handle according to local process. All customers using international mail services should be directed to a Retail Customs Terminal (RCT) in locations that support an RCT.
- Educate customers about the convenience of completing many of their mailing transactions online at www.usps.com including the completion of customs forms for international transactions.

All SSAs behind the retail counter should be aware of the Lobby Assistant's process of initialing packages to determine when the HAZMAT question has been asked. SSAs and Lobby Assistants should communicate on the types of codes or markings (such as initials or dimensions written on large packages) that will be used as an indication of customer's preparedness to reduce redundancies in asking questions of the customer.

Non-Mailing Transactions

For other non-mailing transactions, steps can be taken to prepare the customer prior to reaching the counter. Some examples:

- Answer any questions or inquiries
- For new PO Box rentals, explain PO Box fees and key policies, have customer complete application, check identification.
- Pick-ups or Hold Mail should be handled according to local procedures to reduce Sales and Service Associates' (SSA) time away from the counter.
  - Direct customer to a dutch door while the item is retrieved.
  - Carry a hand-held scanner to scan accountable pick-ups.
  - Inquire of all customers in the lobby to see if anyone else has a pick-up to reduce multiple trips to retrieve items.
- If the customer is writing a check, the lobby assistant can validate the customer's Identification
- For passport requests, explain the process and documentation needed and have the customer complete the application.
- Stamps customers should be educated on the types of stamps and alternate locations for purchasing stamps such as consignment locations, partner locations or online.

If the customers are properly prepared prior to reaching the retail counter, SSAs at the window will be able to quickly process the customer's transaction and assist more customers in less time. This will result in reduced wait time in line, a more efficient office, and more knowledgeable and satisfied customers.

Directing the Customer to the Self-Service Kiosk (SSK)

In the modern world, banks have installed ATMs, grocery stores have introduced self-checkout stations and airlines now conduct many of their transactions on self-service kiosks. The Postal Service needs to similarly modify customer behavior and concepts on transacting their retail business in this new environment.

Whenever new self-service units are introduced in the private sector, lobby assistants initialize customers to the self-service environment, provide direction, and answer questions to facilitate a successful conversion. Interviews with USPS customers show that 39% would be more likely to try the self-service unit, if they had assistance. A Lobby Assistant is integral in the conversion of customers to self-service.

In sites with a Self-Service Kiosk (SSK), the Lobby Assistant should monitor the line to identify transactions that are eligible for the SSK in order to redirect customers from the line to the SSK. The Lobby Assistant's role is to introduce customers to self-service, describe the functions that are available and answer questions. Before customers are directed to the SSK identifying questions should be asked to determine if the customer's mailing needs can be completed at the self-service kiosk. Customers should operate the kiosk themselves, but Lobby Assistants should be available to answer questions and provide assistance if they appear uncomfortable or unsure.

Lobby Assistants in sites with SSKs should:

- Educate the customer on the SSK capabilities and postal products and services.
- Explain the different mailing options and services provided by the Self-Service Kiosk.
- Keep postal forms and shipping supplies replenished and located near the SSK.
- Encourage the customer to conduct their transaction. If the customer is reluctant, walk through the transaction with them but let them operate the machine.

NOTE: VERY IMPORTANT – Before pulling a customer from the line and directing to the SSK, it is imperative that:

1. The customer is able to pay with a credit or debit card.
2. The transaction is a SSK-eligible transaction.

The Lobby Assistant should ask questions to determine if the transaction is SSK eligible:

1. "Do you have a debit or credit card that you can use for your business today?"
2. If the customer does not have anything in their hands, ask if they are purchasing stamps and if so, ask the quantity.
3. "Are you mailing that package or flat?" If so, this would be an SSK eligible transaction.
4. "Are you sending the article Priority or Express?" If so, this would be a SSK eligible transaction.
5. "Do you need insurance?" If so, this would be an SSK eligible transaction, however, the customer can only purchase up to $5,000.00 in insurance at the SSK.
6. "Is your package international?" Only international correspondence less than 16oz can be mailed at the SSK. If it requires a custom forms it cannot be performed at the SSK. This includes APO/FPO mailings requiring customs forms.
7. For customers renewing a PO Box, advise them that they can renew on the self-service kiosk.

If the transaction is not SSK eligible or the customer chooses to use the full service counter, the Lobby Assistant should prepare their transactions in order to reduce the time spent at the counter.

It is not necessary to walk the customer thru the entire transaction. Direct them to the machine, and start the transaction. Let the customer do the rest. Only assist with the transaction if you see the customer struggling.

If necessary, make sure you show the customer:

- Where the retail items are scanned on the Self Service Kiosk (if applicable)
- Where their Credit/Debit card is swiped
- Where the postage labels are dispensed
- Where the large mailing labels (SSL –Standard Shipping labels) are dispensed
- Where the customer receipt is dispensed
- Where to deposit their packages and other mail prepared on the SSK (In Wall collection box, Free Standing collection box or Boise parcel slide)

Mention the benefits of using the kiosk –

- Will minimize their time at the Post Office
- Eliminate or reduce time spent in line
- Provides English and Spanish language options
- Provides a receipt with information regarding their transaction including tracking numbers
- Lobby Assistant available to provide help or answer questions, if needed.
- Provides 24/7 or extended access (where applicable)

The Lobby Assistant should monitor the SSK and to ensure it is readily available for the customers' transactions.

- Timely responses to SSK alerts will be within 30 minutes.
- Report machine problems to manager to keep the SSK in working order at all times.
- Perform a clean-up of the machine by wiping it down, and removing any dust and debris buildup. Follow the exact frequency and cleaning procedures in the SSK Cleaning Manual. Preventive maintenance prevents breakdowns.
- Keep the SSK area neat and clean. Make certain there is an adequate supply of forms and Express/Priority packaging placed in the Express/ Priority Supplies (EPS) display and adjacent to the SSK.

Self Service Kiosk Functionality

In order for the Lobby Assistant to direct customers to the SSK they need to be able to identify SSK eligible transactions.

The Self Service Kiosks have the following functionality:

- Weighs and prices letters, large envelopes and packages up to 70 pounds
- Purchase Forever Stamps – choice of 6 Black and White designs through Print on Demand (POD). May purchase 1 to 100 with a minimum purchase of $1.00
- Purchase postage stamps of variable rates through Print On Demand (POD)
- Purchase postage for Express Mail, Priority Mail, First Class Mail and Standard Post to ship letters, flats and domestic packages
- May renew PO Box

- Obtain information on prices, ZIP Code look up and mailing information
- Provides Track and Confirm look up for Express Mail and delivery of items shipped using USPS/Delivery Tracking Confirmation
- Purchase Extra Services including Insurance and Certified Mail
- May scan and purchase ReadyPost packaging, greeting cards, and other retail merchandise if the SSK has a scanner
- Send international letters but not parcels due to required customs documents

Items that ***cannot*** be processed on the self-service kiosk include:

- Shipments to APO/FPO locations
- International merchandise and packages (anything requiring a customs form)
- Media Mail
- Signature Confirmation
- Money Orders (Domestic and International)
- International Reply Coupons
- Registered Mail

When you direct customers to the self-service units, allow them to conduct the transaction themselves. This will assist in making them more comfortable using the self-service in future visits. Remember, to thank your customers for using the SSK and remind them of the convenience of 24/7 availability; even on holidays and weekends.

Tools for Lobby Assistants

A lobby assistant must be prepared with essential items to assist customers. Use a small mail tray, apron, or cart to carry necessary items or stage them in an easily accessible location, such as a package preparation counter.

This technique saves the lobby assistant time by having forms and supplies on hand rather than searching shelves, form holders, or going to the back office to retrieve the proper items to assist customers with their mailing needs.

Suggested list of tools:

Forms

- Signature Confirmation (PS Form 153)
- Insurance (Domestic $200 or less)
- Insurance (Domestic over $200-Blue)
- Certified Receipt (PS Form 3800)
- Return Receipt (PS Form 3811)
- Customs (PS Form 2976)
- Customs Declaration and Dispatch Note (PS Form 2976-A)
- Express Mail (Label 11)
- Change of Address (PS Form 3575) if requested by customer
- Official Change/Correction to Mail Forwarding (PS Form 3546)

Shipping Supplies

- Express Mail Envelopes
- Priority Mail Envelopes
- Priority Mail Small Box
- Stamped Envelopes
- ReadyPost Envelopes
- ReadyPost Tape

Applications

- Passport Application (DS 11, DS 82)
- P.O. Box Application (PS Form 1093)

Miscellaneous

- Your Guide to International Mailing (Pub 613)
- HAZ/MAT Information (Notice 107)
- Price List (Notice 123)
- Priority Mail Stickers
- Priority Mail Address Label
- Pencil
- Pens
- Highlighter
- Tape
- Tape measure
- Post It Notepad
- Scanner
- Walkie Talkie (if applicable)
- Language Translator Guides **http://blue.usps.gov/humanresources/professionalportal/edd/inclusiveness/outreach/translation%20aids.shtml**

Ancillary Duties as a Lobby Assistant

Lobby Assistants should be present in the lobby at all times the window is open. If customer traffic briefly becomes slow, the Lobby Assistant should remain in the lobby performing ancillary duties. The Lobby Assistant needs to be ready to assist in the lobby for arriving customers in order to create a positive customer experience.

Lobby Assistants should monitor their lobby to ensure it presents a clean, professional image to customers. Debris should be removed from counters and writing tables.

Any down time should be used to straighten lobby, replenish supplies and forms, and perform other tasks as needed:

- Some offices may have multiple Expedited Package Service displays (EPS); all displays should be monitored to replenish inventory in the inner and outer lobby. Shipping supplies include, but are not limited to:
  - Express Mail envelopes, Tyvek, and boxes (flat and variable rate)
  - Express Mail address labels and stickers
  - Priority Mail envelopes, Tyvek, and boxes (all sizes including flat and variable rate)
  - Priority Mail address labels and stickers
- Extra services forms and applications should be replenished and straightened:
  - Insurance
  - Certified Mail
  - Signature Confirmation
  - Registered Mail
  - Return Receipt (domestic and international)
  - Certificate of Mailing
  - Customs forms
  - Passport forms (new and renewal, if applicable)
- Restock and straighten retail merchandise, as needed. Retail merchandise includes, but is not limited to:
  - ReadyPost items; tape, bubble wrap, decorative boxes
  - Greeting Cards
  - Gift Cards
- If an extra POS unit or ACE computer is available in the lobby area, the Lobby Assistant can input customs forms that have been bypassed by the Sales and Service Associates (SSAs) during the same day.
- Ensure proper POP signage is displayed and identify old or outdated signage. Check for display “up” and “down” dates in corner of signage. Notify manager if required signage is damaged or needs replacement.
- Lobby Assistants should visually inspect lobby and exterior area of Post Office. Ensure the flag is in good condition and correctly hung, and notate any cosmetic or safety issues in the lobby to the site manager such as loose displays or tables.

- If a location or cart can be secured in the lobby, the Lobby Assistant can process second notices on accountable items when not assisting customers.
- A communications folder containing service talks, new products tip sheets, Retail Digest and other material can be kept in the toolkit for review during down time.
- If a site has a Self Service Kiosk (SSK), the Lobby Assistant should perform weekly maintenance and cleaning on the machine and replenish consumables.
- The Lobby Assistant can assist by counting the ReadyPost inventory in the lobby if an audit is needed.
- If an Ace computer is available on window, the Lobby Assistant can input PostalOne data, WebBATS inputs, update PO Box renter information or order stock/supplies.
- The Lobby Assistant can place hang tags on vacant PO Boxes to advertise their availability.
- The SSK collection drop should be monitored and emptied to avoid overflows and jams. Acceptance scans should be given when applicable.
- The Retail Customs Terminal consumables should be monitored and replenished (for RCT sites).

The last Lobby Assistant on duty when the retail window closes should ensure that all supplies are well stocked for customers using the self-service kiosk after the window is closed.

Summary

The goal for the Lobby Assistant is to try to approach every customer in order to prepare them for the transaction before they queue, reducing the number of unprepared customers that reach the counter. Unprepared customers cause bottlenecks at the window, and create long wait times for customers behind them. Prepared customers reduce wait time and result in increased customer satisfaction and a better experience for all customers.

Lobby Assistants must be proactive in identifying customer needs, preparing customers for the counter and moving basic customer transactions to self-service kiosks. This reduces unprepared customers approaching the counter with incomplete forms or product uncertainty. The end result will be efficient, convenient service, greater satisfaction and customer retention.

Module 2: Self-Service Kiosk (SSK) Guidelines

Objective:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Describe functionality transactions available on the SSK
- Identify components of the SSK
- Name the responsibilities of a servicing employee
- Differentiate alert types
- Apply steps when reporting Help Desk incidents
- Explain key and refund policies

Time Allocated for Module:

- 1 hour

Instructional Methods:

- Lecture

Summary:

- Self-Service Kiosk (SSK) and Customer Experience
- Component Overview
- Servicing Employee Responsibilities
- Safety Procedures
- Logging on to service the SSK
- SSK Alerts and Help Desk
- Ordering Consumables and Cleaning Supplies
- Preventative Maintenance
- Key and Refund Policies
- SSK/APC Web Page, Best Practices and Available DVDs

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- ACE Computer, LCD projector, and PowerPoint presentation

Self-Service Kiosk

The Self-Service Kiosk (SSK), both new and legacy models, provides general postal services to customers.

Customers are able to purchase stamps (Print on Demand – POD), Express, Priority, First Class Mail, and Parcel Post postage to mail letters, flats, and ship packages. Additional features available are renewal of PO Box rental, pricing, ZIP Code information, and perform looking up track and confirm information. Customer can also purchase Extra Services with postage, ReadyPost supplies, greeting cards, and other retail merchandise.

Customer Experience

Using SSKs provide benefits to the customer including English and Spanish language options, alternative method of purchasing products and services, and is convenient. Legacy APCs provide alternate access after hours, generally 24 hours a day, seven days a week, and inner Lobby kiosks are available when the store is open.

This option increases customer satisfaction and assists offices with reducing their Wait Time in Line (WTIN).

SSK Component Overview

Components of the SSK that customers and servicing employees will frequently access are; the touch screen, security camera, PIN pad, left or right side printer, scale, rulers, scanner, and lastly the receipt output.



A brief description of each component is:

- Touch screen – Data entered by customer and the servicing employee
- Security Camera – Photographs the user
- PIN Pad: allows the customer to enter PIN # when using a debit card
- Left Side Printer - Prints SSL – Standard Shipping Label
- Right Side Printer – Prints postage labels on the 2 across label stock
- Scale - Used to weigh and rate items
- Rulers –Assists customers with measuring packages during the mailing process
- Scanner: Scans items for sale –Ready Post, greeting cards and other retail merchandise
- Receipt Output – provides customer with a receipt of their transaction

SSKs are equipped with an External Drive to provide back up data and an Uninterruptable Power Supply (UPS) that is a battery back up allowing completion of the current transaction during power failure.

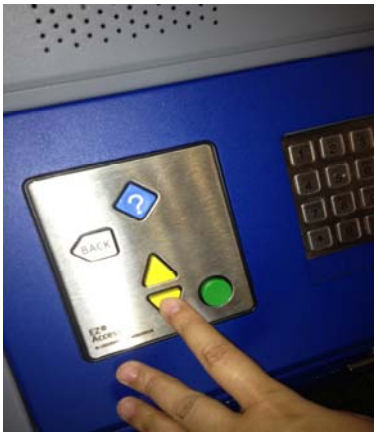
Handicap, Hearing, and Visually Impaired Accessories

There is a headset jack and volume control buttons for customers to insert their headphones and listen to audio directions on using the kiosk. The audio directions will navigate through the screens. The labels for the volume control are printed and have braille and embossed symbols.

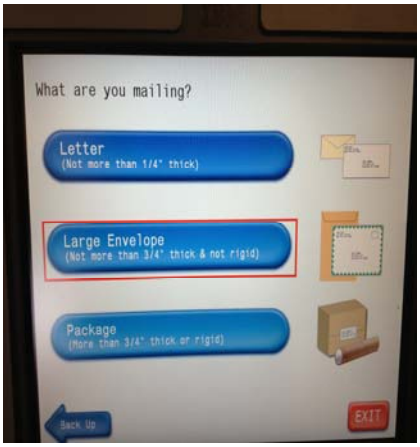




Visually impaired customer can navigate through the screens with the easy access keypad. When using the EZ Access keypad, the selected item is highlighted in red.



EZ Access Keypad



Screen display

Every kiosk is side positioned wheelchair accessible**.**

Responsibilities of a Servicing Employee

The servicing employee has several responsibilities. They include:

- Order and replenish consumables (labels and receipt paper)
- Respond to kiosk alerts within 2 hours (alerts present when shift begins should be responded to within 1 hour)
- Clear jams (labels and receipt paper)
- Contact the Help Desk when alerts cannot be resolved
- Install Level 1 parts sent by the Help Desk to resolve alerts (no tools)
- Return all replaced parts promptly (to ensure site is not charged)
- Escort and log in for Level 2 technicians
- Provide preventive service (cleaning the kiosk)
- Service kiosk at least 3 times per day – before opening, prior to lunch or busy periods and before closing – ensure kiosk operational and stocked
- Report any physical damage to site manager

Warnings

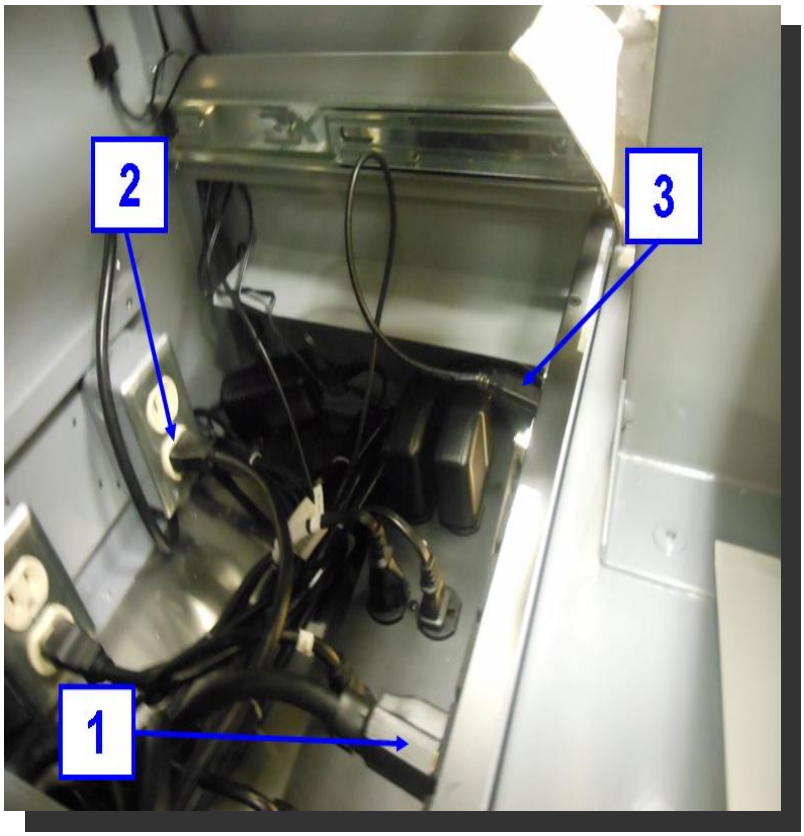
When servicing an SSK, employees are to follow specific safety procedures. These procedures will protect the employee from electrical shock hazards and potential equipment damage. Before servicing the SSK, remove all jewelry from hands and wrists, and then turn off the kiosk power switch and uninterrupted power source (UPS).

When connecting or disconnecting power cables from devices attached to the kiosk, always hold the plug of the power cable and never pull the cable itself. Use one hand, when possible, to connect or disconnect signal cables to prevent a possible electrical shock from touching two surfaces with different electrical potentials. Lastly, during an electrical storm, do not connect power or signal cables on the SSK.

Removing Power from UPS

To remove the power from the uninterrupted power source (UPS), first, locate the UPS on the shelf underneath the left side and right side printer in the Front Panel Enclosure.

Slide the UPS out approximately half of the way so you can see the plugs and cable connections in the back of the UPS.

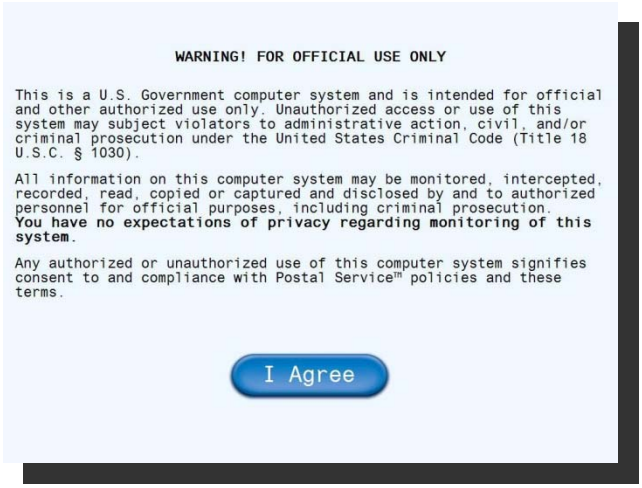


Disconnect by unplugging:

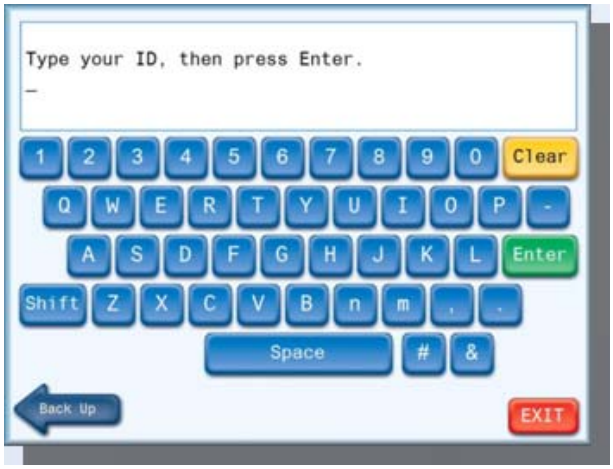
1. Power strip connection to all devices
2. UPS connection to a dedicated circuit
3. USB communications cable to the SSK

Logging on as a Servicing Employee

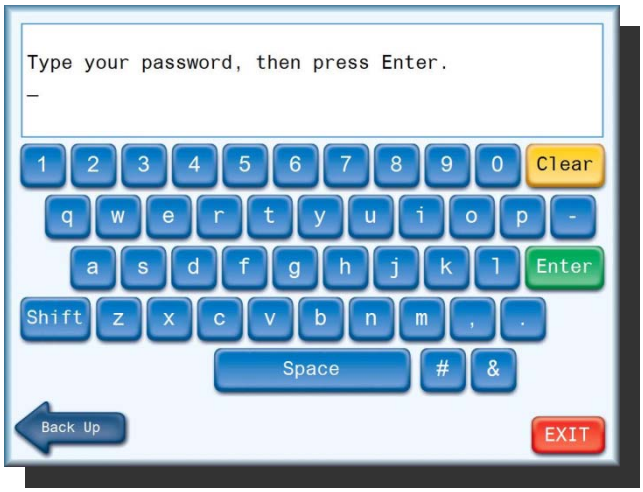
To log on, you must have approval through eAccess. The customer main menu screen will be visible on the kiosk. Access the Front Panel enclosure using SSK key.



You will be presented with a warning screen; Press I Agree.



Type in your User ID (ACE Log On), then press Enter.



Type in your ACE password, and then press Enter.



Touch the Service Employee Only button. The Servicer Main Menu Screen will display.

Servicer Main Menu

Options available from the Service Main Menu screen include:

- View/Resolve Alerts
- Test Vends
- Diagnostics
- Replenishment
- Print Reports
- System Functions
- Enable Door Key
- Credit Exam

Alert Types

Alerts identify problems such as jams, other malfunctions, or the need to replenish consumables.

If an email alert remains unresolved after the first escalation period, a second email alert is sent to the servicing employee (SE) and the Site Supervisor.

If the alert remains unresolved after the second escalation period, an email is sent to the SE, Site Supervisor and District Designee. The first escalation period is 2 hours and the second escalation period is 4 hours.

Fatal Alerts are those that indicate a loss of functionality. Critical Alerts indicate the loss of a specific feature, and a Warning Alert indicates that a consumable item needs replenishing.

Critical alerts that directly affect sales include:

- Left Side and Right Side Printer Empty
- Left Side and Right side Printer Jams
- Receipt Printer Paper Empty and Receipt Printer Paper Jam
- Card Reader Error, Camera error, and Scale error

Help Desk

The help desk assists in resolving problems or tickets associated with loading consumable, clearing jams, resolving Level 1 alerts, removal and replacement of Level 1 parts, and navigating and entering information on service screens.

The help desk will order replacement Level 1 parts, dispatch Level 2 technicians as necessary, enter service calls from SEs and generate trouble tickets, and close trouble tickets as appropriate. When calling the help desk, use Help Desk Log Sheet to record the call.

The Help Desk number is 1-800-877-7435. Assistance is available 7AM to Midnight Eastern Time, Monday through Friday and 7AM to 6PM Eastern Time on Saturday.

Contacting the Help Desk

When calling the Help Desk, Provide the following information:

- Servicing Employees name, Ace ID and phone number
- USPS address or site ID number
- An alternate contact name and telephone number
- Description of the problem
- Type of alert received
- Condition of kiosk; is it operational or not operational
- What assistance is needed

Let the Help Desk know if the problem is recurring. The Help Desk will provide the name of person assisting you, the ticket number, if a technician is coming and their estimated arrival time, or if the part will be shipped (generally overnight service). If asked to perform a task and call Help Desk back, ensure that you do.

Help Desk Log

Record the Help Desk information on a Help Desk Log Sheet available on the APC website.

Returning Defective Parts

When receiving Level 1 parts, a bright PINK label with a picture of the kiosk will identify them. Inside the container will be a copy of the removal/replacement procedures, pre-addressed return shipping label, and pre-paid postage are included in plastic sleeve attached to the outside of the part's shipping container.

When the servicing employee completes the parts replacement activity they will do the following:

- Insert the defective part into the received shipping container of the new part.
- Place the return label on outside of the shipping container.
- Mail to the repair facility identified on the label.
- Keep a record of the part type, tracking number, and date returned.

Missing parts mean missing revenue! The site will incur charges for parts not returned.

Ordering Consumables

Place orders for SSK consumables through eBuy2. Consumables consist of:

Labels (same for legacy APC and new SSK):

- O7522L - Print On Demand Fanfold Labels (Two-Across) for Right Side Printer: NSN # 7690150007201 $189.60/carton – 25,500 labels
- O7522J - Continuous Roll Labels for Left Side Printer: NSN # 7690130006916 – Standard Shipping Label (SSL) $69.50/carton 2 rolls/carton

Legacy APC SSK Receipt Paper:

- O7522RP Receipt Paper: NSN # 7690070000602 $20.31/carton 4 rolls/carton

New SSK Thermal Receipt Paper:

- Zebra Stripe Receipt Paper for SSK:NSN # 7530160008511 $102.92/carton 8 rolls/carton

NOTE: All sites will be receiving Holiday media – rolls of Right Side Printer Paper pre-printed with a holiday design.

Keep adequate supply on hand to avoid running out of supplies and do not use any consumables greater than 1 year old.

Cleaning Supplies

This table provides a list of cleaning supplies you will need to stock and the order number is applicable for eBuy 2.

Product Name	Order Number
Touch Screen Cleaner	eBuy 2 – S6HPC-1061-W/D
Universal Cleaning Cloths	eBuy 2 – N290H68
Cleaning Card for Card Readers	eBuy 2 – NSN # 7035-09-000-9208
Thermal Printer cleaning kit	eBuy 2 – 3LGU6
Cotton tipped Swabs	Obtain locally
Isopropyl Alcohol	Obtain locally
Cleaning Brush	eBuy 2 - 00351098
Lint-free cleaning cloths	eBuy 2 – N1024675

Preventative Maintenance

The table lists required preventative maintenance procedures, materials, interval in which performance of procedures is to occur, and time needed to complete each task.

SSK Devices	Procedures	Materials	Interval & Time Needed
PIN Pad & EZ Access Keypad	Clean keys	Cleaning brush & wet cleaning cloths	Monthly/as needed – 3 min
Card Reader	Clean card insertion slot & magnetic heads	Cleaning Brush, cloth and universal cleaning card	Monthly/as needed – 3 min
Touch Screen	Clean screen	Cloth & screen cleaner	Weekly/as needed- 2 min
Scanner Opening	Clean cover	Cloth & screen cleaner	Weekly/as needed- 2 min
Camera Lens Cover	Clean cover	Cloth and screen cleaner	Weekly/as needed – 2 min
Printers (2)	Clean paper dust & foreign materials	Cleaning brush, cotton swabs, alcohol & cloth	Semi-monthly or with change of paper stock whichever comes first-15 min
Receipt Printer	Clean sensors	Same as above	Weekly/as needed – 5 min
Kiosk Exterior	Clean steel & plastic	Cleaning brush & cloth	Monthly/as needed – 2 min

Key and Refund Policies

Sites with Legacy APCs received nine keys per kiosk. Six keys are for servicing employee keys and three are supervisor keys. The supervisor key is no longer restricted for use by a supervisor. Any issues with locks and keys are referred to the SSK Help Desk.

Each individual assigned servicing responsibility must complete the SSK Sign Out Log when picking up keys at the start of business day and return the keys at close of the business day. Return keys to the designated location at close of the business day. Keys are not to be removed from the site. Multiple SSK sites must label keys and store former APC and new SSK keys separately.

New SSK Key Policy

Sites with the new SSKs receive six keys per kiosk. These keys are identical and unique to the specific site and will only open the new SSKs assigned to the site.

The key opens two locks on the Front Panel Enclosure and one lock on the Scale and Measuring Station. Issues with locks and keys are referred to the SSK Help Desk.

Each individual assigned servicing responsibilities must complete the SSK Sign Out Log when they pickup and return their keys at the start and close of a business day. Return keys to the designated location at close of the business day. Keys are not to be removed from the site. Multiple SSK sites must label keys and store former APC and new SSK keys separately.

Key Accountability Log

The illustration below is an image of the Key Accountability Log.

(Site Name)		(Unit ID)							(Month – FY)
SSK Key Accountability Log		Page _____ of ____.							
Date	Servicer Name (Please Print)	Key Accountability - Servicer Hand-off							Comments
		Out	Time	Initials	Return	Time	Initials		

Refund Policy

Create a file folder to track all Self-Service Kiosk refunds. The intent of the folder is a tool for management analysis of refund activity.

Keep records in this file separate from all other daily documents. A copy of PS Form 3533, *Application and Voucher for Refund of Postage, Fees, and Services,* must be kept in the SSK refund document file.

Reference the SSK Webpage (http://apc), Finance Issues, Refunds and Exchanges for the complete process.

POD Forever Label Refund

For Print-on-Demand (POD) labels, use the customer's receipt to verify that the Credit/Debit Card was charged and that the system could not credit the customer's account.

To perform a refund for a POD "Forever" Postage Label that was not dispensed successfully to the customer, create a stamp sale using AIC 007 for the credit amount due the customer. Offset the transaction with GL Adjustment to AIC 486.

If the customer has left their stamps at the Kiosk, complete PS Form 3533, mark the POD labels void, and keep onsite.

Variable Rate Refund Policy

Employees can only exchange equivalent value of stamps and at no time are cash refunds allowed. SSK postage labels that are reused, modified, cut, removed from letters and packages will not be accepted for refund.

Exchanges will be at 100% of value. You will need to obtain label from the customer and physically mark such as void and then the customer must complete a PS Form 3533 with signature.

SSA records transaction as follows:

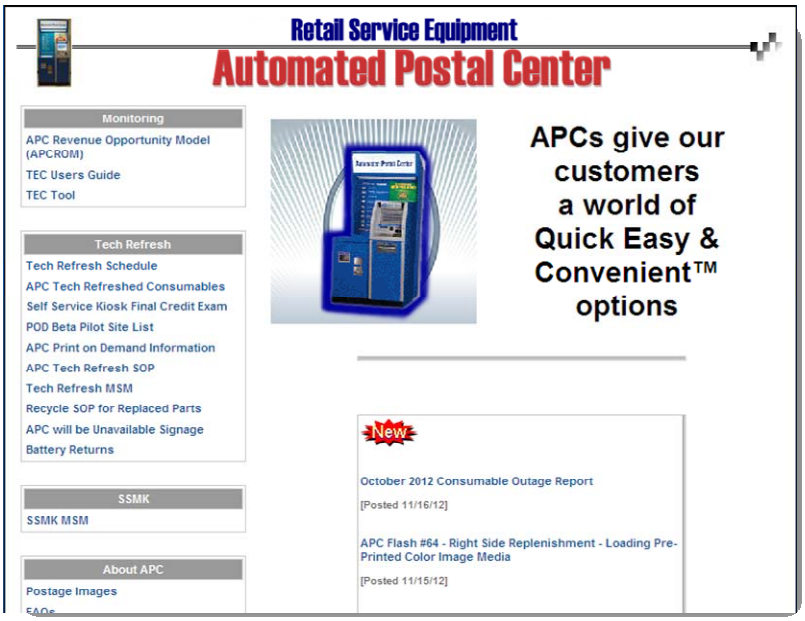
- Perform a stamp sale (AIC 090 or 007) for the amount of SSK Postage Label
- Enter the same amount into AIC 552, SSK Variable Rate Postage Meter Rejects (SSK Only)
- Net total for this transaction must be $0.00
- See SSK Webpage (http://rse2/apc/) – Finance Issues – Refunds & Exchanges for complete process.

Resources

The SSK/APC Webpages: http://apc and http://rse2/apc/- provide a number of resources to support the SE in performance of their duties.

Samples of resources include:

- SSK Machine Service Manual
- Refunds and Exchanges
- Cleaning Manual
- Flash Reports





Best Practices

Best practices provide a list of things you can do to ensure that SSKs in your facility provide customers with an optimal experience:

- Keep SSK fully stocked and operational
- Ensure a SE is on site in the event of alerts
- Use Lobby Assistant to familiarize customers with the SSK and encourage them to use it by assisting with transactions
- Empty SSK collection box regularly (wall, free standing, and hamper behind Boise parcel slide)

Available DVDs

Available resource DVDs entails replenishing consumables and replacing level 1 parts.

- Receipt Paper
- Left Side Printer
- Right Side printer

Replacing Level 1 Parts

- Log On/Shut Down
- Card Reader
- PIN Pad (Please do not show trainees how to remove the PIN Pad during OJT –it is a breech of security and the PIN Pad must be replaced if you attempt to remove it)
- Receipt Printer
- Label Printers
- Touch Screen

Summary

In this module, we discussed transactions that can be performed on the SSK, pointed out components of the SSK, related responsibilities of the servicing employee, described alert types, procedures when using the Help Desk, key, and refund policies. The Self-Service Kiosk generates revenue while providing customer convenience and helps maintain wait time in line.

Appendix

SSK FAQs

Note: Familiarizing yourself with customer frequently asked questions will be helpful.

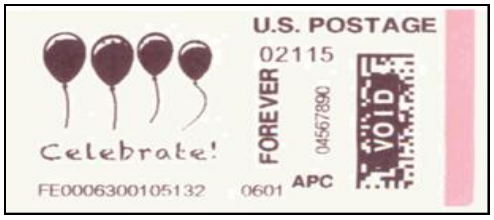
Q. What does a Self-Service Kiosk do?
A. Currently, 45 % of all customer visits at the retail counter can be completed in their entirety at the Self Service Kiosk. These include:

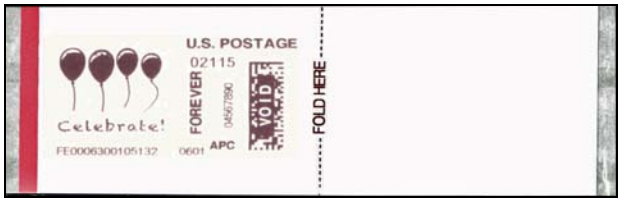
- Weighs and prices letters, large envelopes and packages up to 70 pounds
- Purchase Forever Stamps – choice of 6 Black and White designs through Print on Demand (POD). May purchase 1 to 100 with a minimum purchase of $1.00
- Purchase postage stamps of variable rates through Print On Demand (POD)
- Purchase postage for Express Mail, Priority Mail, First Class Mail and Standard Post to ship letters, flats and domestic packages
- May renew their PO Box
- Obtain information on prices, ZIP Code look up and mailing information
- Provides Track and Confirm look up
- Purchase Special Services including Insurance and Certified Mail
- May scan and purchase ReadyPost packaging, greeting cards, and other retail merchandise if the SSK has a scanner.
- Send international correspondence up to 16 ounces.
- Provides English and Spanish language options
- Provides a receipt with information regarding their transaction including tracking numbers

Items that ***cannot*** be processed on the self-service kiosk include –

- Shipments to APO/FPO locations
- International merchandise and packages requiring a customs form
- Media Mail
- Signature Confirmation
- Money Orders (Domestic & International)
- International Reply Coupons
- Registered Mail

Sample of Print on Demand (POD) Forever postage:





Q. Why will the SSK only accept International letters less than one pound?
A. Because international letters less than one pound do not require a customs form.

Q. Does SSK weigh and rate?
A. Yes, the SSK weighs and rates envelopes, flats and parcels up to 70 pounds.

Q. Can you use the scale without completing a transaction?
A. Yes, you can initiate a weigh/rate transaction to weigh an item without completing the transaction.

Q. Does the SSK sell stamps only? Will the SSK vend actual stamps/coils/booklets?
A. No, the SSK dispenses First Class Forever Print on Demand stamps in multiple quantities (minimum of $1.00 total) as well as postage strips in any denomination over $1.00 and postages strips for Priority Mail, Express Mail, and International. The SSK will not vend single stamps or coils.

Q. Is there a date on the postage strip?
A. Yes, the postage strip shows a ***"Date of Sale"*** and the postage amount.

Q. Will the SSK accept credit/debit only? What about cash?
A. The SSK is a cashless machine and accepts payment via credit or debit cards only.

Q. Which credit cards are accepted?
A. All major credit cards including Visa, Master Card, American Express and Discover.

Q. Will the customers need to enter credit/debit cards for every transaction?
A. Credit Cards

1) The customer can purchase multiple items on one credit card dip.
2) Each credit card dip has a limit of $50.00, which is a pre-determined limit that has been set by the credit/debit process for self-service.
3) The daily limit for each credit card is $80.00.
4) If a customer's total visit exceeds $80.00, credit card payment is not offered as a choice, only debit. (*If the customer does not want to pay with debit, they could cancel the transaction and purchase within multiple visits, multiple indicia's that would total to the amount needed to mail the article).*

B. Debit Cards – There are no local/daily limits, only the amount of money that is in the customer's account. Maximum single transaction is $134.95 and each mailing requires a separate "dip."

Q. Is there going to be a Self-Service Kiosk in every Post Office?
A. Not at this time.

Q. Can APO/FPO parcels be mailed from a SSK?
A. No. Parcels to APO/FPO addresses require handling at the window because of customs requirements.